Burners ? OSE Conversions

In the spirit of *The White Hack*, *The Black Hack*, and *The Black Sword Hack*, this is **the Burners Hack**. Use the original roleplaying game — through the lens of how Old-School Essentials has cleaned it up — **unless Burners says otherwise**. Modules, treasure types, morale, reaction, turns, and the rest come in as written; this page is the routing table for where the Hack replaces or reframes a piece. Every conversion also follows [[Burners Principles]].

Clocks. OSE turns and rounds are Burners turns and rounds. Durations and light burn as written (torch 6 Turns / one hour-cycle, lantern 24 per flask; candles on [[Burners Equipment]]). Wandering monsters: [[Burners Referee Guide#Turn Tracker]] — always 1-in-6; roll on even turns and again when noise, dark, or wounds fire. OSE's plain check every other turn is the time signature. OSE's "rest one turn every hour or −1 to hit" is not used; Burners recovers HP with an [[Burners Adventure Game#Wounds|Hour Rest]] (a full quiet cycle, food and water, unwounded) instead.

Default (keep as written). Morale (2–12 on 2d6); reaction (2d6 — add **Heart** if a Burner leads the parley); number appearing; Treasure Type and coin values; movement as relative speed. Treasure XP and shares: [[Burners Experience]] (the deed rule, magic 0 XP, monster parts not XP, Eldar column).

XP Awards

Burners uses OSE monster numbers on its own level table (see [[Burners Experience]]). Port treasure types and coin values as written; award treasure XP at the **deed** that wrests it from the dungeon. Shares and part-out: [[Burners Experience]]. Eldar use the double-XP column.

Source	Award
Monster overcome	Printed OSE XP, or HD chart below
Coins, gems, jewelry	1 XP per 1 gp, credited at the deed
Goods, art	1 XP per 1 gp, credited at the deed (Ref sets gp)
Magic items	0 XP — the item is the reward
Weapons, armor, tools	0 XP — the kit is the reward
Monster parts	gp or kit — 0 XP
Bounties	town coin — 0 XP

Level when you next sleep somewhere safe after your XP crosses a tier (see [[Burners Experience]]).

Monster XP by Hit Dice (OSE)

HD	XP	HD	XP
under 1	5	7	950
1	10	8	1,900
2	20	9–10	2,750
3	60	11–12	4,500
4	125	13–16	6,000
5	250	17–20	8,500

HD	XP	HD	XP
6	500	21+	10,000+

For fractional or special HD, **prefer the monster's printed XP** or the full OSE Awarding XP table (base + bonus per ∗ ability). This short chart is a coarse shortcut — e.g. HD 3 reads **60** here, but an OSE Wight (3*) is **50 XP**.

Converting a module hoard. Roll or place treasure as OSE directs. Coins, gems, jewelry, goods, and art pay **1 XP per gp**, credited at the **deed**: a guardian killed beside its hoard credits everything in its grasp, found or not; a trap beaten credits the room it guards; sneak past and only what is carried off pays ([[Burners Experience#The deed pays]]). Note in your key what each foe guards and its full value. The Referee sets each find's gp once (now or later). Magic items, weapons, armor, and tools pay **0 XP**; the thing is the reward. Carcass parts (hide, tusks, ivory) may sell or be useful kit — **0 XP** ([[Burners Experience#Part out]]). Delving retainers: OSE half-share if not Mustering; Mustering seats split half of their Boss's XP (see [[Burners Muster]]). Full procedure: [[Burners Experience]].

Monsters

The Stat Line

OSE	Burners
HD	Level, 1:1. **Monster Stack** = **2 × HD** playing cards (face-down closed / face-up open).
XP	Award when overcome — **XP by HD** from the table in *XP Awards* (a 1 HD skeleton = 10; HD 2 = 20). Use the module's printed award if given.
AC	Hint for the **face mix** only — soft kit → some face-down; shell/plate → mostly face-down; naked/sushi → all face-up. Suggest a **right tool** fiction (poleax, slicing, silver…) players may claim for the extra Fuel die.
Damage die	Quote weight for Referee speed attacks (d6 → quote 3, etc.) — see [[Burners Referee Guide#Monsters at speed (preferred Referee mode)]].
Saves	Deleted — route the *ability* through the Defend Router
Morale	As written
THAC0 / attack bonus	Deleted — there are no to-hit rolls

2 × HD Monster Stack (face mix)

See [[Burners Principles#Armor soaks; monsters use Monster Stacks]] and [[Burners Referee Guide#Monsters at speed (preferred Referee mode)]]. **Monsters do not use PC Armor Class.**

Referee speed (preferred):

1. Deal **2 × HD** playing cards onto the table.
2. Paint the **face mix**: naked/sushi/no kit → **all face-up**; soft kit (leather, shield) → **some face-down**; mail/heavier → more face-down; true shell/plate/scales → **mostly or all face-down**. Soft armor **adds face-downs into the mix** — not a flat soak outside the budget.
3. Hard shell/plate / sushi often suggests a **right tool** (poleax, slicing, silver…) — claiming it lets a player burn **one extra Fuel** into the blow. Hits are always ⌈damage ÷ 5⌉; closed → **−1**, always, while any face-down remains.

Do **not** invent a tiny soak "just because the book had AC." AC 1–2 as flat damage reduction was a **Referee math tax** — players never changed tactics for it.

Worked: **orc in leather** HD 1 → **1 down / 1 up**. **Wolf / naked tough → all face-up** (2 × HD). **Wet Devil** HD 8 → **16 face-up**. **Giant crab** HD 3 → **6 face-down**; poleax as right tool. **Knight in plate** → heavy face-down in 2 × HD; magic or pollaxe as right tool. **Dragon** → mostly face-down; name fire / soft underbelly / etc.

When a PC **loots** a suit of armor off a foe, that kit becomes ordinary Burners AC for the wearer — the monster's face-down cards were the table paint, not PC AC.

The Damage Die → quotes (and optional full-dice)

Preferred Referee play is **scene Heat + free quoted attacks** — no free monster Defend — [[Burners Referee Guide#Monsters at speed (preferred Referee mode)]]. The OSE damage die sets **quote weight** (and optional full-dice ports when you run a foe like a PC). Initiative is the group **1d6**, not Heat.

Quote from the die (preferred):

OSE damage die	Quote (rough)
1d4	**2**
1d6	**2** or **3**
1d8	**4**
1d10	**5**
1d12, 2d6+	**5** (or two quotes)

Optional full-dice ports (named foes you want to burn Fuel like a Burner): treat the damage die as weapon slots for blow weight — 1d4 → 1 slot, 1d6 → 2, 1d8 → 3, etc. — and roll a Fuel pool. See [[Burners Arms and Armor]]. Most nights, don't.

Natural attacks are quotes (or weapon slots on a full-dice port), not Fuel.

Initiative: each distinct foe group rolls **1d6** every Round Initiative (same as [[Burners Adventure Game#Combat]]). Heat is unpaid Risk, not the Initiative dish. Optional full-dice foes may roll a Fuel pool like a Burner — label that choice at the table. Fiction tempo still holds:

- **Shambling** *(the sluggish dead, oozes, rooted things)*: **acts last**, skip the d6.
- **A living spear** *(cobra, ambush-hunter)*: acts at the **top of the order**, skip the d6.

Charge *(a beast closing at a run — where OSE pounce/leap riders convert)*: a situational bump the Referee adds to the quote — as any situation can bump a blow (see [[Burners Adventure Game]]). **Shambling** things never get it.

Receive a Charge *(maneuver — a braced longer weapon, and you must see it coming)*: your thrust strikes **first**, before the rush lands, and the charger's rush adds to *your* blow instead. If it survives and presses in, its attack resolves as normal.

Multi-attack routines (claw/claw/bite): the Referee sets how many **quotes** the creature throws (a wolf bites once, a bear claws twice, a hydra strikes per head), each defended separately. Spread them across several characters, or land them all on one.

Spellcasting monsters: convert their list through the Spells section, or skip the list and quote each casting as a blow or a telegraph. A dragon does not need a spellbook; it needs a Breath telegraph and two good tricks. Wizard-type foes and libraries: leave **true writings** — each **one named 1st**, school labeled — see *Enemy true writings* on [[Burners Referee Guide]].

The Defend Router

An OSE save is a pointer to a Burners subsystem — see [[Burners Principles#Route, don't reinvent]] and [[Burners Principles#Granular defense, not binary save]]. `2d6 +` **the fitting Approach** against the Referee's Risk handles most hazards (see *Approach Roll* in [[Burners Adventure Game]]). Hostile magic uses Fuel Defend against the caster's cast total (see [[Burners Sorcerie]]). Ask what the save protects, then route it:

OSE says	Burners does
Save vs. Breath	**Area effect** — see [[Burners Principles#Telegraph the unwinnable]].
Save vs. Poison (or die)	**Defend** (Craft) to avoid; **lingering Cost** once it lands. See [[Burners Principles#No instant death]].
Save vs. Paralysis	**Defend** (Craft or Sword) at the touch; fall short and you **stiffen** for a stated clock (ghoul-chill, 2d6 rounds) — recoverable, not permanent.
Save vs. Petrify	**Counting doom**: repeated **Defends** (Craft or Sword), each miss a step toward stone; it recovers. Averting your eyes is the counterplay, at the price of fighting blind.
Save vs. Spells / Wands / Rods / Staves	Fuel **Defend** vs **cast total**; roll initiative OOC. See [[Burners Principles#Granular defense, not binary save]] and [[Burners Principles#Harm and effect are separate lanes]]. **Ward:** adjacent Sorcerer burns ≤ Sorcerie Level Fuel to cut the attack, then each ally Defends.
Save vs. Death effects	**Shock Check** and **Wounds**, then post-fight help + Craft survival — see [[Burners Principles#No instant death]] and [[Burners Adventure Game#Wounds]].

Which Approach? Craft to dodge a dart, pit, or poison; Sword to force a door, hold your feet, or stay conscious; Heart against fear and horror; Sorcerie to dredge up what you know against the uncanny. The player may argue for another Approach if the fiction fits. When in doubt: Craft to avoid, Sword to endure.

Deriving a Score (when a module needs a raw number)

Burners has no ability scores on the sheet. On the rare occasion a module wants an actual number — an opposed feat of might, a stat-keyed gate — derive one on the fly as **10 + the fitting Approach level**:

Old score	Approach
STR	Sword
DEX, CON	Craft
WIS, CHA	Heart
INT	Sorcerie

So a Sword 3 stands at an effective 13, a Craft 2 at 12. This is a fallback for the odd direct comparison, not a number to track — most endurance routes through a **Defend (`2d6 +` Approach)** and most contests are a **Pay** or **Deal** roll the same way.

"Magic Weapons to Hit" → armor + right tool

See [[Burners Principles#Armor soaks; monsters use Monster Stacks]].

OSE says	Burners	The feel
Silver or magic to hit	Heavy **face-down** in the 2 × HD mix; players may claim silver/magic as the right tool (one extra Fuel into the blow)	*Resistant.* Everyone eats the −1 while face-down stands; the smart play is the claim.
+1 or better to hit	Same; right-tool fiction = legendary blade or stated weakness	*Unearthly.* Mortal steel is folklore; the right edge makes it mortal.
+2/+3 or better to hit	Same — the right tool may need *discovery*, or a fiction gate (*phylactery*)	*A puzzle wearing a stack.* Not a bigger soak number.

The **right tool** is a **player claim** (fiction + one extra Fuel burned into the blow), not a Ref auto-switch — see [[Burners Principles#Armor soaks; monsters use Monster Stacks]]. Same spirit as a Bane-forged weapon (see [[Burners Arms and Armor]]).

Undead

Run the printed OSE block as written — HD, attacks, specials, Morale, printed XP. Do not rebuild the monster. Player rules: [[Burners Burn Undead]]. Table procedure: [[Burners Referee Guide#Undead]].

Instead of energy drain / levels lost: damage from undead does not come back with rest (magic or Purge). Purge: one Incendiary; gain a Wound equal to the HP you are purging. An undead Wound worsens at midnight by `1d6` + HD, then Survival. Anyone slain by undead rises unless you burn their bones. Undead that drain levels in OSE curse one Trait per level drained with each touch instead (a spectre or vampire curses two) (see *Trait Curse* in [[Burners Burn Undead]]).

Instead of Cleric Turn Undead: some undead can be driven back by fire. Husks that fear it recoil from a brand; the brand is the right tool. Willful undead laugh at a bare flame. They do not die unless purged in fire.

They sense the living; they do not rely on natural senses.

Grab, constrict, swallow, rake-and-hold: Constrict in [[Burners Adventure Game#Combat]].

Keep every other printed special (gaseous form, regeneration, charm, paralysis, disease, silver/magic to hit). Silver/magic to hit is face-down + right tool, above.

Mobs vs. the unearthly: see [[Burners Principles#Armor soaks; monsters use Monster Stacks]].

Checks, Doors, and Skills

A module check splits two ways. A trained or skilled attempt — thief skills, foraging, listening at doors — becomes `2d6` **+ fitting Approach vs Risk**, quoted as a **Pay** (the world acts on you — shortfall is Heat) or a **Deal** (you act on it — shortfall is no purchase). A raw attribute check with no skill behind it — bend bars, leap a chasm, stare down a horror — is the same: `2d6` + Sword, Craft, or Heart vs the Referee's Risk.

OSE chance	Heat
5-in-6	6
4-in-6	7
3-in-6	8
2-in-6	9

OSE chance	Heat
1-in-6	10

Stuck doors, thief skills, foraging, listening at doors — all this table. A trained Approach shifts the odds; that is the point of being a Burner.

Traps and environmental damage — see [[Burners Principles#Pools, not fixed numbers]] (*Traps*). Average the module die to flat Damage; detect or eat.

Worked in the margin — the OSE zombie (AC 8 [11] · HD 2 (9hp) · 1 × weapon, 1d8 · Morale 12):

> **Zombie.** HD 2 → **4 face-up** (AC 8 → no kit, all-up sushi) · Heat dish for the side · **Shambling** — acts last · Morale 12 as written · **XP 20**. Quote fists as heavy (**4**).

Read straight off the printed block — 2 × HD cards (face mix), Heat, right-tool-if-any, tempo, Morale.

Spells

Port OSE spells onto [[Burners Spells]] when a match exists; otherwise write a one-line effect in the same format (`School L: …`).

- **Spell level = cast level SL.** Hand holds prepared cards; Sorcerie slot count sets hand size; Arcana rides in Sorcerie slots at full item cost (books and scrolls may too — fill the slot). Sleep recovers up to caster Level cards (untap/burn/lasting); redraw or one-hour swap needs a readable source.
- **Durations and ranges as written** — the clocks match.
- **Casting (combat):** one Action; burn at least SL Fuel dice, roll them — cast total = sum of faces. Tap the card. On a Spark, Fuel it with one or more additional Fuel dice, up to SL, for extra effect; unfueled, it fades. May burn ready cards in the same Action to recast or copy.
- **Casting (NPC / module caster):** roll at least **SL Fuel dice** for the cast total the same way. A hostile cast **rolls initiative** if no fight is underway.
- **Defense and damage:** see [[Burners Principles#Granular defense, not binary save]] and [[Burners Principles#Harm and effect are separate lanes]]. Ignore OSE per-caster-level dice and fixed damage lines; overrun to HP 1:1. *Save for half* does not port.
- **Scrolls** require a **Sorcerer** (or Journeyman + Canting for Canting) — single-use items, any form; not cards (see [[Burners Sorcerie]]).

Magic Items

Potions, rings, cursed items, and wondrous items port **as written** — they are fiction plus a rule, and the fiction is the value. **Magic items grant no XP**; the item is the reward (see *XP Awards*). Wands and staves that fit **Arcana** ride in Sorcerie slots at full slot cost (costume Arcana 100 gp in town; enchanted Arcana is a find — see [[Burners Sorcerie]]); they do not add hand cards. Item powers run as magic items, or for a one-off keep charges as a simple budget.

+n Arms, Shields, and Armor → Enchanted + Powers

Convert *+1 sword*, *+2 shield*, *+1 plate*, and so on per [[Burners Referee Magic Items]] — extra die, +n powers, Tuned / Bane / relic ladders, and the OSE power menus all live there. Trait for the extra die: [[Burners Adventure Game#Enchanted Arms and Armor]]. Keep Slots, AC, and size as the mundane piece.

Potions, rings, and wondrous items stay as written above. Do not raise AC or size for a plus.

Watchpoints

- **Lethality is comparable** — B/X at low levels is brutal and Burners characters are lean. Large mobs can spike past any defend; use swarm splitting and chokepoints.
- **Foreshadowing is mechanical** — see [[Burners Principles#Heat is collateral]].
- **Solo bosses** need enough face-down (and face-up) in 2 × HD to survive the party's first-round burst, or they die before their first telegraph.
- **Don't double-count dread** — see [[Burners Principles#Heat is collateral]].

> *Read the stat block once, write it in the margin — 2 × HD cards (face mix), Heat, right-tool-if-any, XP by HD — route the saves through Defend, and run it.*